

INDIVIDUAL REPORT

WEBSITE: PIXIU FLOW

GROUP 2 - NGUYEN BAO NGOC



HANOI, 8TH JUNE 2026

Website: PixiuFlow

Profit and Loss Tracking for Small & Micro Businesses

Full Name	Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc
Student ID	2313380022
Group	2
Role	UX/UI Designer
Project	Website - PixiuFlow



1. Role in the Project

In the PixiuFlow project, I took on the role of UX/UI Designer, with primary responsibility for user experience research, product flow design, interface design, and maintaining design system consistency across the entire platform.

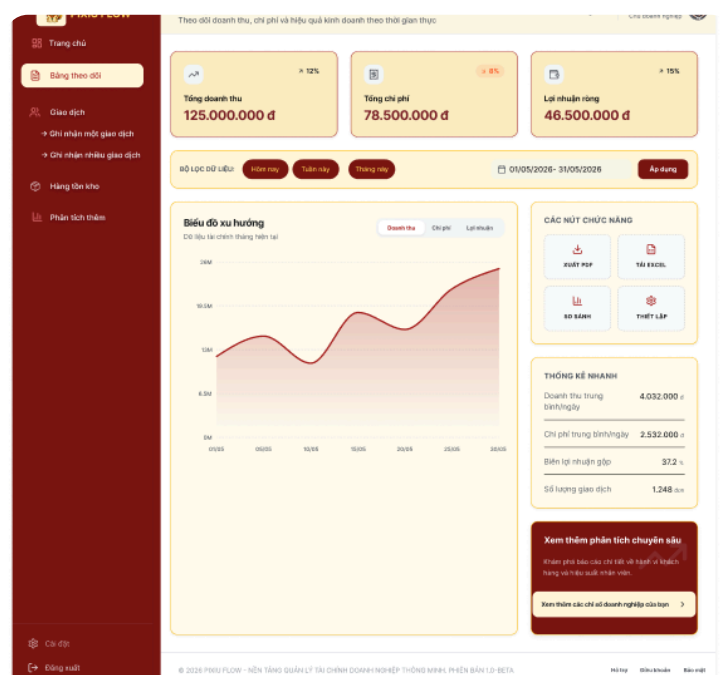
Beyond visual design, my responsibilities extended across the full product-thinking lifecycle:

- ▶ Analyzing and translating user requirements into actionable design decisions (Based on the sitemap conducted by other members who are responsible for
- ▶ Designing User Flows that map every step a user takes across core features
- ▶ Creating Wireframes and high-fidelity Prototypes to communicate design intent
- ▶ Standardizing the user experience across all major system modules
- ▶ Collaborating with other designer to ensure visual and interaction consistency

My scope covered the first half of the design workload, from initial research and structural planning (with the whole group) through wireframing and component system setup before handing off to the member who took the responsibility for front-end development to implement the remaining screens into code.

2. Personal Impact on the Product

My most significant contribution lies in establishing the end-to-end user experience foundation for PixiuFlow, from the moment a user first signs up or registers the account through encounters the product, all the way to monitoring business activity, analyzing profit performance and receiving additionally financial analysis.



The core design challenge I focused on was **making a financial management tool that is accessible and intuitive for small and micro-business owners** (also, website users who typically have little formal training in finance or technology).

Every design decision I made was filtered through the lens of this target user group:

1. Can they understand this at a glance?
2. Is this action obvious without instructions?
3. Does the layout reduce cognitive load?

Key design principles I embedded into the product:

- ▶ **Simplicity over completeness:** Show what matters, progressively reveal complexity
- ▶ **Visual clarity:** Use charts, color-coded indicators, and whitespace as communication tools
- ▶ **Consistency:** One design language, one interaction pattern, applied everywhere
- ▶ **Task-oriented layout:** Design screens around user goals, not system structure

3. Actual Task Completion



Task 1: User Research & Product Architecture

This foundational phase was **carried out collaboratively as a team** during the first project phase. Rather than jumping straight into screen design, the group collectively invested time in understanding the problem space thoroughly before any individual work began.

- ▶ **Researched the core problem:** How small and micro-business owners currently track revenue, costs, and profit, and where existing solutions fall short
 - **Identified key pain points:** manual tracking via spreadsheets or notebooks, lack of real-time visibility, and inability to distinguish profitable product lines
- ▶ **Defined primary and secondary user personas**
 - **Primary:** Owner-operator of a micro-small retail or food business, managing transactions daily
 - **Secondary:** Part-time bookkeeper or family member assisting with financial logging

► **Agreed on all core features:**

- **New user onboarding flow:** sign up → business profile setup → first transaction entry
- **Daily transaction logging flow:** add revenue/expense → categorize → confirm
- **Report generation flow:** select period → view summary → drill into product/category
- **Inventory management flow:** add item → link to transactions → monitor stock level

► **Brainstormed the general page list and site structure as a group:**

- Collectively identifying the core pages the product would need (Landing, Login/Sign Up, Dashboard, Transactions, Inventory, Reports, Settings)

Task 2: Visual Research & Design Direction

Before designing any interface, my design partner and I spent significant time establishing a clear visual language for PixiuFlow - one that would be professional yet approachable to non-technical users.

► **Benchmarked competitor and reference products**

- Analyzed financial management apps (Kiot Viet, SaPo POS) for IA patterns
- Studied SaaS dashboards on Pinterest focused on data visualization
- Reviewed how revenue/expense charts are presented in apps targeting non-accountants

► **Built a moodboard capturing the target visual style**

- Curated 30+ reference images spanning dashboard UI, data visualization, typography, and color palettes
- Identified a direction: clean, data-forward, with warm accents to reduce the coldness of financial tools

► **Developed the color system for PixiuFlow**

- Selected a primary palette (deep navy blue for authority and trust)
- Defined semantic colors: green for revenue/positive, red for expense/loss, amber for alerts
- Ensured sufficient contrast ratios to meet readability standards

► **Curated the icon library and illustration assets**

- Selected a consistent icon set aligned with the product's visual tone
- Sourced or created illustrations for empty states and onboarding screens

Task 3: Interface design and UX implementation

With the structure and visual direction established, I moved into detailed design following the agreed sitemap. The screens were divided equally between my design partner and me, and I took responsibility for the first half, covering Landing Page through to the Transaction Record (Revenue) screens, building out each interface screen by screen while setting up the shared component system.

► **Designed low-fidelity wireframes for all screens in my scope**

- Established layout grids, content hierarchy, and interaction zones before adding visual detail
- Ran quick team reviews on wireframes to catch structural issues early

► **Built the shared UI Component Library in Figma**

- Input fields, dropdowns, date pickers, toggle switches, and form validation states
- Button variants (primary, secondary, ghost, destructive) with hover and disabled states
- Card components for metrics, transactions, and product summaries
- Chart container templates (line chart, bar chart, donut chart) with placeholder data
- Navigation components: top navigation bar, sidebar, breadcrumbs, tab groups
- Notification and toast message components

► **Designed high-fidelity interfaces for the following screens (first half of system)**

- Landing Page: Value proposition, feature highlights, call to action, social proof section
- Login/Sign Up Pages: Clean authentication screens with field validation feedback
- Dashboard-KPI summary cards, revenue and expense chart, recent activity feed, quick-entry button
- Transaction History: Filterable and sortable log, transaction detail drawer, bulk action toolbar

► **Collaborated with my design partner to ensure visual continuity across both halves of the system**

- Shared the component library and design tokens before they began work on their screens
- Conducted joint review sessions to align spacing, typography, and interaction patterns
- Resolved inconsistencies iteratively through versioned feedback in Figma

Task 4: Prototyping and Design Handoff

With the structure and visual direction established, I moved into detailed design following the agreed sitemap. The screens were divided equally between my design partner and me, and I took responsibility for the first half, covering Landing Page through to the Transaction Record (Revenue) screens, building out each interface screen by screen while setting up the shared component system.

► Built an interactive prototype in Figma covering the primary user journeys

- Sign up → onboarding → first transaction entry
- Dashboard overview → drill into report → view product performance
- Add inventory item → link to transaction → check stock status

► Iterated on design based on team feedback

- Refined dashboard layout after feedback that KPI cards were too dense
- Simplified the transaction entry form based on internal usability testing

► Standardized the design for developer handoff

- Annotated key screens with spacing values, color tokens, and interaction notes
- Organized Figma pages and layers for easy navigation by developers

4. Files, Features & Contributions



Deliverable	Description
Moodboard	Visual reference board establishing PixiuFlow's warm - deep crimson as the primary brand color against a cream background, with gold accent details drawing from Vietnamese cultural visual patterns
Color System	Brand color palette built around deep crimson red as the primary color, warm cream as the background, and gold/amber for highlights, conveying trust and approachability for Vietnamese small business owners

Deliverable	Description
Wireframes	Low-fidelity wireframes for all screens in scope (Landing, Auth, Dashboard, Transactions)
UI Component Library	Shared Figma component set: buttons, inputs, cards, charts, navigation, notifications
Landing Page	Overview of PixiuFlow, About us, Sign-up and Registration button
Login / Sign Up	Split-screen authentication layout: deep crimson brand panel with Pixiu mascot on the left, warm cream form panel on the right; includes multi-step onboarding flow (account creation → business profile → initial inventory declaration → dashboard)
Dashboard	Main tracking view with three KPI summary cards (total revenue, total expense, net profit) in cream cards with crimson trend indicators, a full-width revenue trend line chart, quick-stat sidebar, and action button
Transaction History	Transaction entry screen with tabbed revenue/expense toggle, multi-level category dropdowns (3 levels), order detail table with inline editing, real-time KPI sidebar showing today's revenue/expense/profit with percentage change indicators, and recent transaction feed"
Interactive Prototype	Figma prototype connecting all screens into three navigable user journeys: new user onboarding (account → business profile → initial stock → dashboard), daily transaction recording (revenue/expense entry → category selection → KPI update)

5. Evidence of Contribution



► [Figma project file](#)

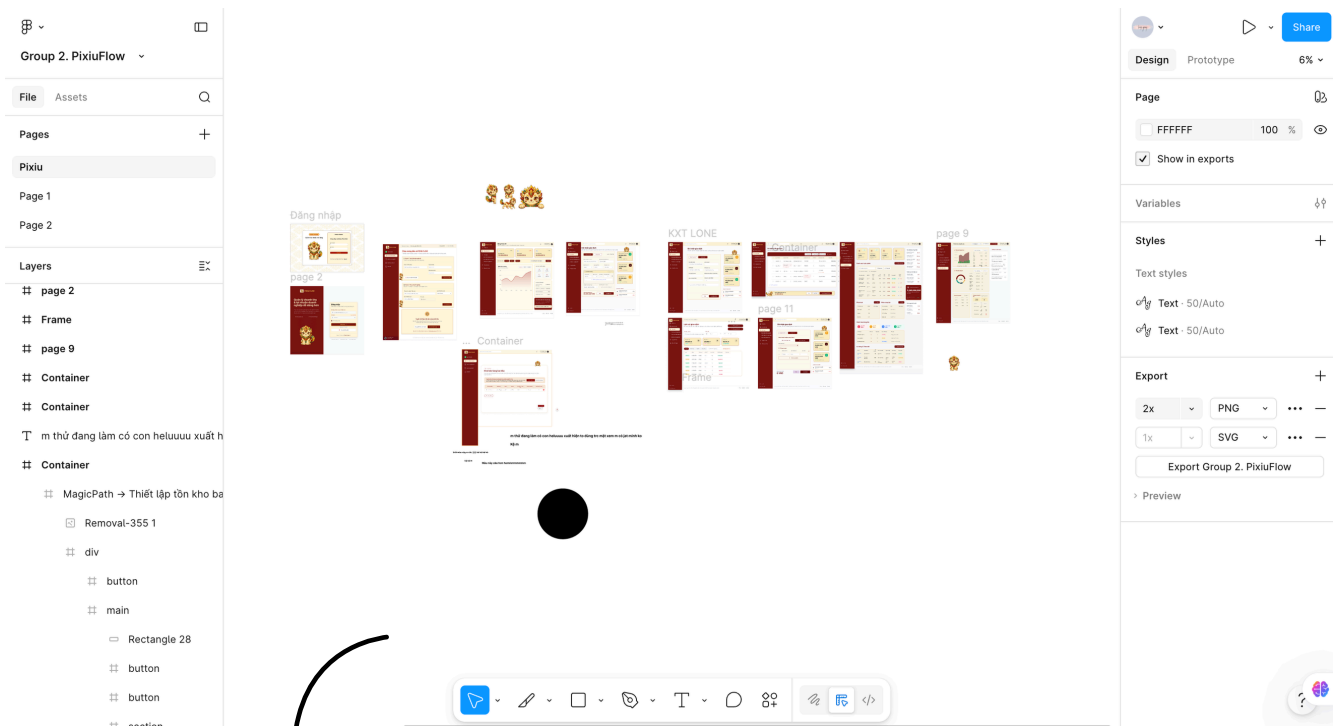


Image 1: Overall Widget of Figma

5. Evidence of Contribution



► Figma edt history

May 19, 1:52 PM

nammoadidaphat

May 19, 1:14 PM

Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

nammoadidaphat

May 19, 1:01 PM

Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

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May 19, 12:46 AM

Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

May 19, 12:34 AM

Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

May 19, 12:00 AM

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May 19, 1:14 PM

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May 19, 12:46 AM

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May 19, 12:34 AM

Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

May 19, 12:00 AM

Jun 3, 10:40 AM

Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

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Jun 3, 10:23 AM

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Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

May 31, 12:46 PM

Jelly

May 29, 3:30 PM

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May 28, 7:28 AM

ok

Nguyễn Bảo Ngọc

18th May: Start to edit final version in Figma

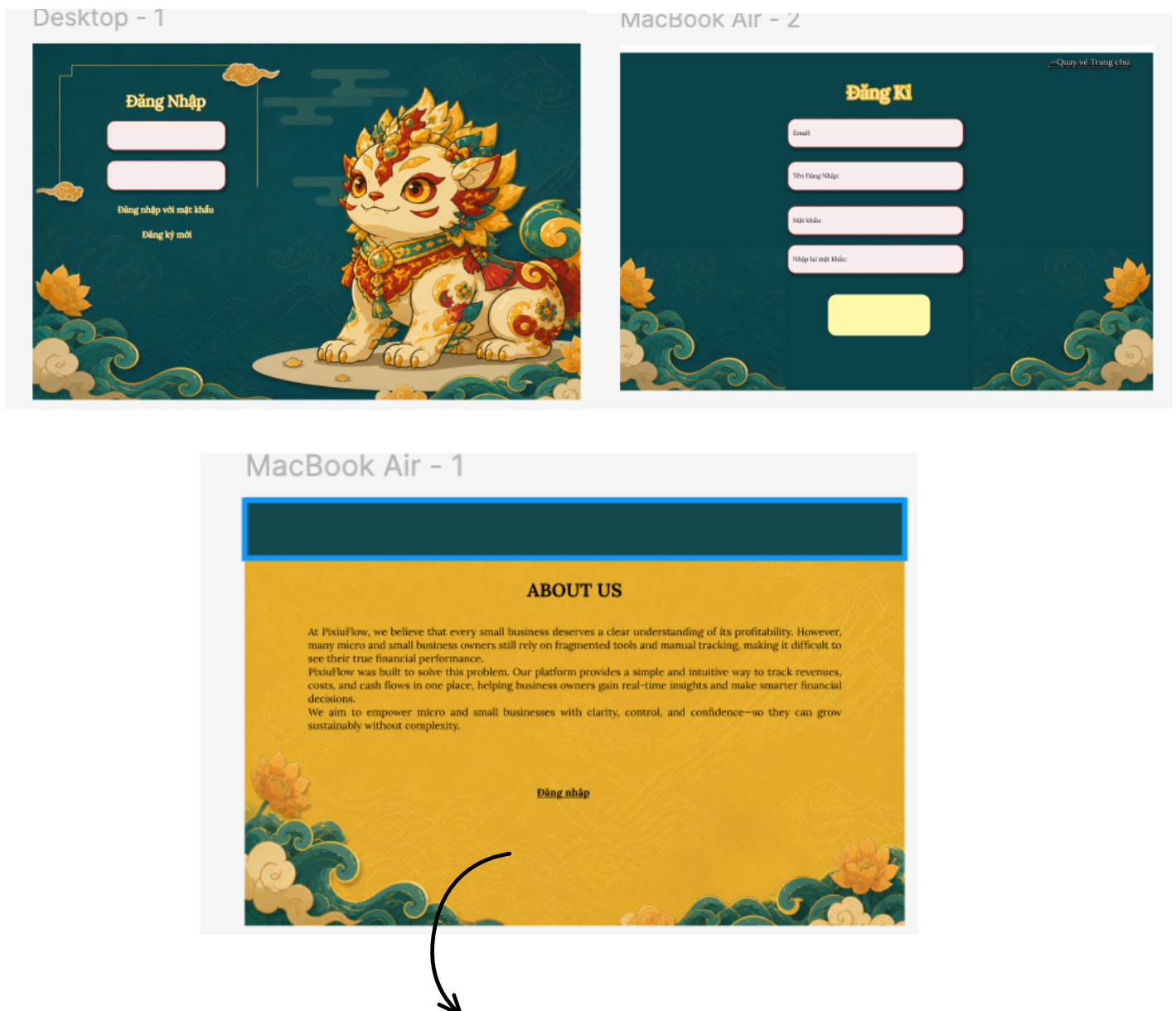
3rd June: Finish final version in Figma

5. Evidence of Contribution



► Screenshots of design versions across the iteration lifecycle

1. First Version in FIGMA



First Idea Brainstorm and Color scheme from 2 UI/UX designers

5. Evidence of Contribution



► Screenshots of design versions across the iteration lifecycle

2. Final Version in FIGMA



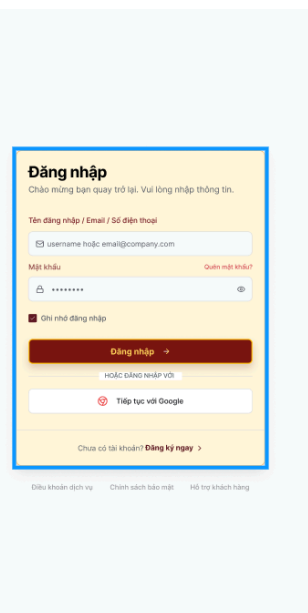
Final Version - Landing page



Final Version - About us



Final Version - Sign-up page

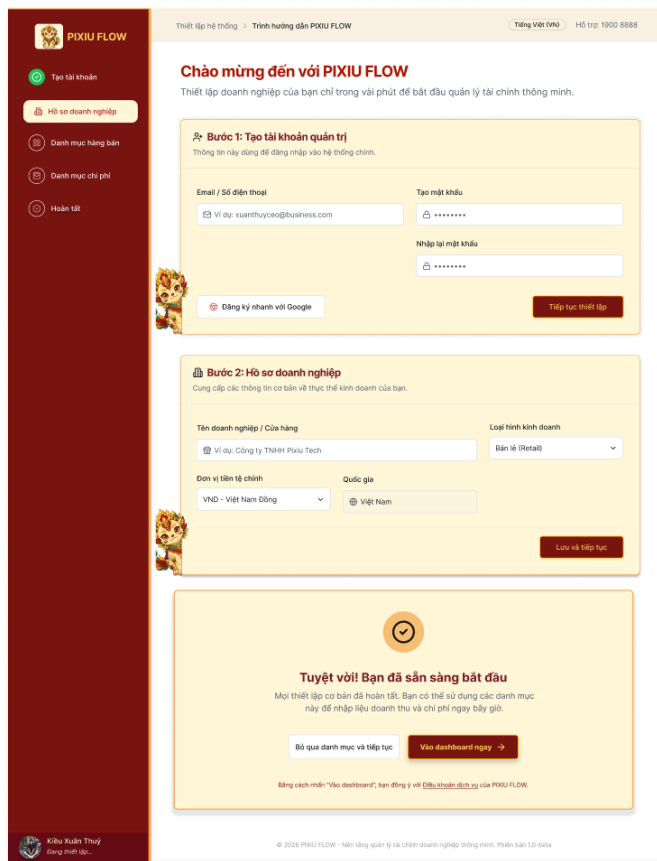


5. Evidence of Contribution

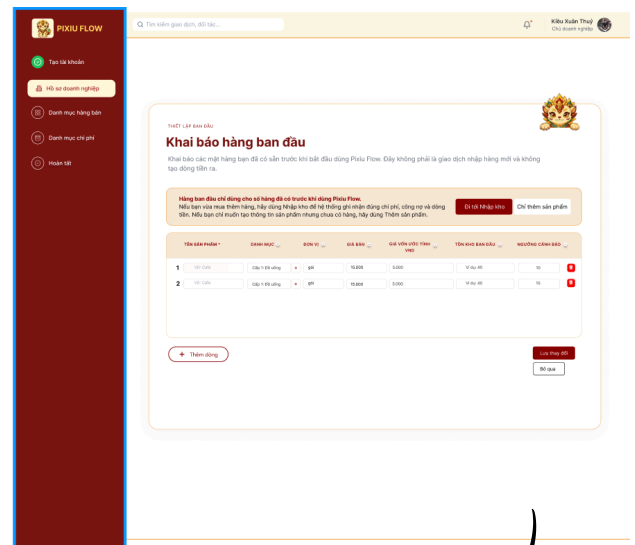


► Screenshots of design versions across the iteration lifecycle

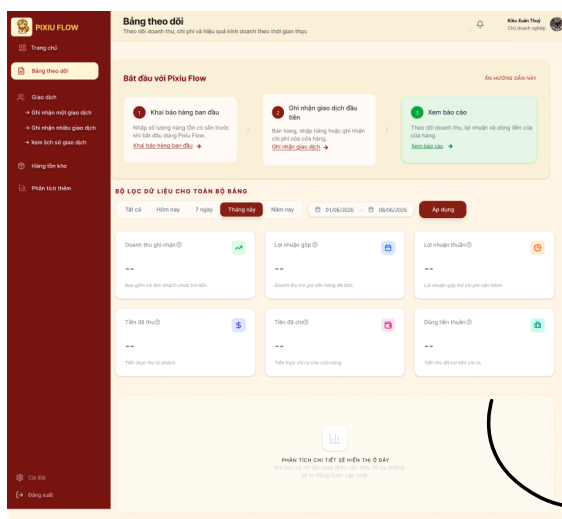
2. Final Version in FIGMA



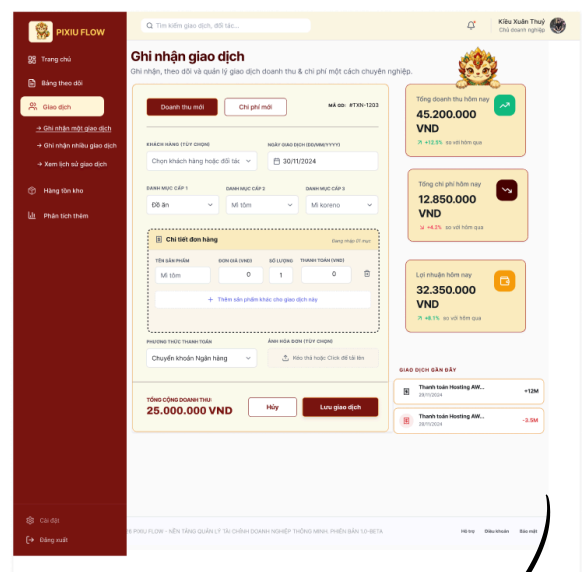
Final Version -
Registration page



Final Version - Initial
Inventory report



Final Version -
Dashboard page



Final Version - Revenue
Transaction Record

6. How my contribution connects to the Final Product



My work **forms the structural and visual backbone** of PixiuFlow. The component library I built became the shared language that both designers used, ensuring that screens designed independently but still consistently throughout the design.

The interfaces I designed (**Landing Page, Authentication, Dashboard, Transactions**) are the primary touchpoints through which users interact with the system. The decisions made in these screens directly shaped the product's usability, visual identity, and the clarity with which the team could communicate the concept during pitching and demo sessions.

By handing off a complete component system, a defined visual style, and collaborated designs of my partner, I enabled the second half of the design work to be completed efficiently and consistently. The final product reflects a cohesive design vision even though it was built collaboratively.

7. Personal Lessons



This project gave me hands-on experience with the full UX/UI design lifecycle in a real product context.

Key things I learned or significantly improved:

- ▶ **How to translate a business problem into a user experience:** moving from 'what the system does' to 'what the user needs to accomplish.'
- ▶ **Information Architecture design:** structuring content so that users can find what they need without thinking about it
- ▶ **The discipline of design systems:** building reusable components that enforce consistency and speed up production
- ▶ **How to work collaboratively** in Figma with another designer without creating conflicts or inconsistencies
- ▶ **The importance of reviewing design at the wireframe stage:** catching structural problems before investing in visual polish
- ▶ **How to give and receive design feedback constructively,** and how to distinguish personal preference from UX principles

8. Challenges and Solutions



Challenge 1: Translating financial concepts into simple, visual interfaces

The core product requires displaying financial data: revenue, expenses, profit margins, and inventory costs to users who are not accountants. Therefore, making this data readable and actionable without oversimplifying it was a significant design challenge.

How I resolved it:

- ▶ Studied how consumer-facing financial apps (like Kiot Viet) present complex data simply
- ▶ Used progressive disclosure: Show summary figures first, allow drill-down on demand
- ▶ Replaced raw numbers with visual indicators (color-coded trends, percentage changes with arrows) wherever possible
- ▶ Tested comprehension informally with team members who played the role of non-expert users

Challenge 2: Maintaining design consistency across a collaboratively built interface

With two designers working on different sections of the same product, there is always a risk of visual drift, slightly different spacing, inconsistent component usage, and mismatched typography.

How I resolved it:

- ▶ Built and documented the UI component library before my partner started their screens
- ▶ Defined spacing rules (8px grid), typography scale, and color tokens as shared constraints
- ▶ Scheduled regular joint design reviews to catch and fix inconsistencies early
- ▶ Used Figma's component publish system so both designers always worked from the same master components

9. Advice for Future Students



- ▶ Start with the user, not the screen. Spend time understanding who your users are and what they are trying to accomplish before opening Figma.
- ▶ Build structure before visuals. A sitemap and user flow will save you enormous rework later → design the logic before the aesthetics.
- ▶ Invest in a component library early. It pays off exponentially as the project grows and makes collaboration much smoother.
- ▶ Wireframes are communication tools, not just drafts. Use them to align your team on layout and functionality before committing to high-fidelity design.
- ▶ A good product is not just beautiful: It helps users achieve their goals efficiently and confidently. Always ask: Would my target user understand this at first glance?
- ▶ Design reviews are not criticism sessions: They are how you make the product better. Learn to present your rationale and be genuinely open to feedback.